Settings

Cartier bracelet | This Cartier bracelet features strands of small chrysoberyl beads supporting a 32.93-carat morganite, an 8.16-carat orange sapphire, and four coloured sapphires. It is also set with brilliant-cut diamonds.

Cat's eye cluster ring | This yellow gold ring from around 1900 features an 11.42-carat central stone of cat's-eye chrysoberyl, surrounded by diamonds.

Honey-yellow cat's eyes | The 11 stones set in this cross pendant are honey-yellow; along with greenish yellow, honey-yellow is the most desirable colour of cat's eye.

Arts and Crafts crescent brooch | This silver and gold brooch by Dorrie Nossiter from around 1930 features varied mixed-gem settings of moonstone, peridot, garnet, chrysoberyl, ruby, sapphire, and green zircon.

Vintage brooch | This Victorian brooch is set with a selection of chrysoberyl gemstones in oval cuts. The lines of the metal setting suggest organic forms.

Alexandrite

Changing colours

The alexandrite variety of chrysoberyl displays a colour change, from greenish to reddish, when seen in different light conditions. Alexandrite appears greenish in daylight, where a full spectrum of light is present, but reddish in incandescent light, because it contains less of the green and blue spectrum. The colour change is due to chromium atoms replacing the aluminium in the chrysoberyl structure. This causes intense absorption of light over a narrow range of wavelengths.

Alexandrite in daylight This cushion-cut alexandrite appears to be green when seen in natural daylight.

Alexandrite in incandescent light The same cushion-cut alexandrite takes on a red hue in incandescent light.